



Dream with Dan August 18, 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zI5gfyGJDts
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City of Muncie Community Meeting & Forum Summary

Meeting Date: (Date not explicitly stated; broadcast/meeting held in evening, concluding at 7:00 PM)

Presiding Officer: Mayor Dan Ridenour

Location: The Innovation Connector (Hosted by Ted)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee work session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:10 The meeting/forum was brought to order and led by Michelle Owen, Director of Communications for the City of Muncie, who introduced the format as part of ongoing civic engagement initiatives ("Dream with Dan" forums).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Official:** Mayor Dan Ridenour
 - **City Officials & Presenters:** Michelle Owen (Communications Director), Officer Deacon (Muncie Police Department), Chief Nathan Sloan (Muncie Police

Department), Laura Ann (Representative from Flock Safety), Deputy Chief Kurzweil, Deputy Chief Deegan, and Deputy Mayor Richard Ivey (mentioned).

- **Members Absent:** None specified in the transcript.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** None recorded in the transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

City Administration & Parks Department Updates

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:02:24 Mayor's City Update & Parks Capital Improvement Program
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Mayor Ridenour reported on recent municipal bond proceeds earmarked for upgrading neglect-affected or completely transforming specific city parks and recreation areas.
 - **Park Projects Detailed:**
 - *Morningside Park:* Finishing previously discussed work with assistance from Roger B.
 - *Tuhey Pool & Park:* Repairs to the pool structure and replacing a slide nearly 15 years old.
 - *West Side Park (Skate Park):* Converting unused model airplane circles into a new skate park at White River Boulevard and Tillotson. Fundraising is being handled by Councilperson Rose Selvi; engineering invoices have already been paid.
 - *Ball Court Park (South Side):* Landscaping repairs to support youth soccer programs.
 - *Heekin Park:* Funds are available, pending final neighborhood selection.
 - *Cohen Park (North Side):* Improvements, primarily focusing on pickleball courts, coordinated with the local councilperson.
 - *Jack's Park:* Clearing out 50-year-old playground equipment and planning a "spring cleaning" with neighborhood input.
 - *Haltoman Park:* A newly ordered pickleball court is scheduled for delivery before November, with late October/November installation.
 - *Anthony Northside Neighborhood:* Partnering with Ball State University via a Memorandum of Understanding to utilize existing playground infrastructure at

the former Anthony Administration Building/elementary school on Oakwood, supplemented with new neighborhood-selected equipment.

- *Riverview Park*: Splash pad installation delayed due to Army Corps of Engineers flood zone permitting requirements. The splash pad is expected within four weeks, while old equipment has been removed and new playground equipment is on order (approx. 18-week supply chain delivery, targeting spring installation).
 - *Till Pond ("Tillotson and Memorial")*: Development of a 6.5-acre pond and 13.5-acre site into an urban free-fishing area, coordinating with the DNR for fish stock and grant applications.
 - *McCullough Park (GameBridge Field / Cal Ripken Field)*: Completion of a \$1.5 million expansion in collaboration with the Cal Ripken Sr./Jr. Foundation, GameBridge, Ball State University, and the City of Muncie (Project Lead: Deputy Mayor Richard Ivey).
 - **Housing & Commercial Revitalization:**
 - *Store Estates Edition & Store Woods Park*: Construction of a 34-lot subdivision and neighborhood park on the former Store Elementary School site, following the resolution of historical neighborhood flooding issues.
 - *White River Plaza*: Revitalization underway by a local investor/property owner; returning the property to tax rolls.
 - *White River Lofts / Canal Square*: Demolition bids were received this past Wednesday and will be accepted next week to clear the empty shopping center.
 - *Markets on Madison (Old Southway Plaza)*: Brick Red Systems moving forward with hiring 30 IT jobs, expanding operations from Seattle, Washington.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded during this segment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only; no formal board vote taken.
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Muncie Police Department: Staffing & Community Crisis Center Updates

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:14:28 Police Department Recruitment and Community Crisis Initiatives
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Officer Deacon & Chief Nathan Sloan
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Officer Deacon reported on recruitment and retention initiatives implemented alongside the mayor's office, the police union, and the Muncie Police Merit Commission. Partnering with *Interview Now*, the department shifted from annual hiring processes to continuous digital recruitment.
 - The current hiring window (deadline September 9) has yielded over 75 candidate communications and 40+ digital applications (compared to 10 applications total in

previous long windows).

- A lateral hiring program for Indiana Law Enforcement Academy-certified officers has brought in 6 lateral hires this year, pushing total active staffing to 104 officers (the highest in 4<U+2013>5 years).
 - Partnering with IU Health to develop a Community Crisis Center targeted to break ground next year, providing a specialized resource for first responders to route individuals in crisis toward social services.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only.
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Muncie Police Department & Flock Safety Initiative

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:18:37 Muncie Police Department Adoption of Flock Safety License Plate Reader (LPR) Technology
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Nathan Sloan, Laura Ann (Flock Safety Representative), Deputy Chief Kurzweil, Deputy Chief Deegan
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Chief Sloan addressed community concerns regarding rising violent crime and gun violence. Neighborhood feedback requested increased patrol, security, and surveillance.
 - The department evaluated License Plate Reader (LPR) technology via "Flock Safety," noting that over 70% of crimes involve vehicles.
 - **Key System Details & Safeguards:**
 - Designed as a force multiplier for investigations (homicides, drive-bys, drugs, stolen vehicles, Amber Alerts, child crimes, construction/catalytic converter thefts, hit-and-runs).
 - **Not** used for routine traffic enforcement (e.g., running red lights); strictly for official criminal investigations.
 - Cameras capture still images of the rear of vehicles and "vehicle fingerprint" data (make, model, color), **not** facial recognition or live biometric video.
 - Data is encrypted end-to-end (AWS government cloud infrastructure) and retained for a hard delete at 30 days, unless preserved for an active investigation.
 - The City of Muncie owns its data; Flock does not sell or share data with third parties.
 - Every search requires an investigative reason linked to an official case number/incident report (CR number), generating proactive reports for the Chief to audit.
 - **Financials & Rollout:**
 - Initiating a **60-day pilot program** at **zero cost** to the city.

- Post-pilot pricing (if adopted permanently) is a flat rate of \$2,500 per LPR device per year plus a small installation fee. Funded via the Mayor's Edit funds.
 - Representatives cited case studies from other jurisdictions (e.g., Gwinnett County, GA) reporting significant drops in violent crime and property crime following LPR implementation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input / Community Q&A:**
 - *Funding & Bidding:* Addressed concerns regarding purchasing thresholds, noting the technology is proprietary/specialized software integrated with statewide policing networks, and executed under a zero-cost 60-day pilot before any fiscal commitment.
 - *Privacy & Foia:* Clarified that data storage is ephemeral (30 days) and restricted strictly to law enforcement purposes.
 - *Human Error / Accuracy:* Acknowledged that human input can contain error, but vehicle identifiers serve as one data point verified through comprehensive investigative work.
 - *Neighborhood Coverage:* Confirmed that neighborhood associations and local businesses can partner to add devices.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information and pilot program launch presentation (no formal council vote required for the 60-day trial).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General community questions were solicited via note cards and online streams, moderated by Communications Director Michelle Owen and addressed collectively by city officials during the Flock Safety presentation Q&A segment. No individual resident floor statements with distinct timestamps were formally entered into the record outside of the moderated Q&A.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reminder of ongoing "Dream with Dan" community forums.
 - Police department recruitment applications remain open online via QR codes through September 9.
 - Future questions can be directed to the City Communications Department.
 - **Adjournment:** 05:51:11 The meeting officially concluded at 7:00 PM.
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